

McKinsey Case Competition 2025

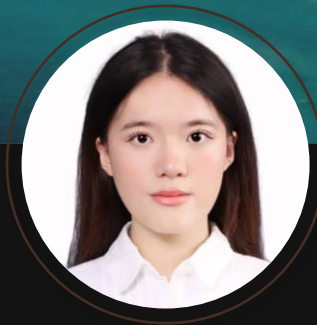
Dallas Team



John



Max



My



Rachel

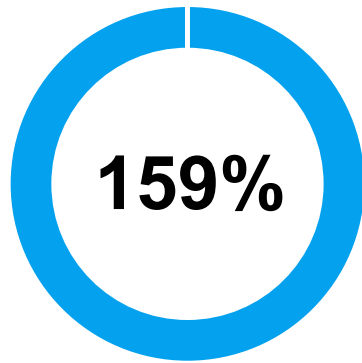


Vedaant

Situation

Since 1960, no Olympic Games have come under budget...

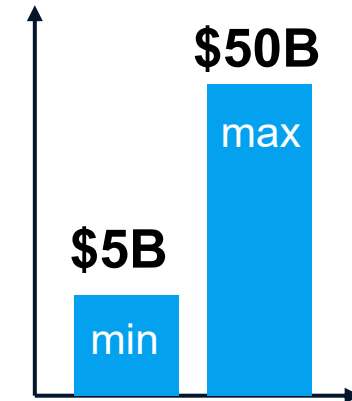
Hosting exposes cities to extreme cost uncertainty...



The **average real cost over-run** is about **159%** (or more) in real terms for Summer Games

Source: The Oxford Olympics Study 2024

... and massive sums to create the necessary infrastructure...



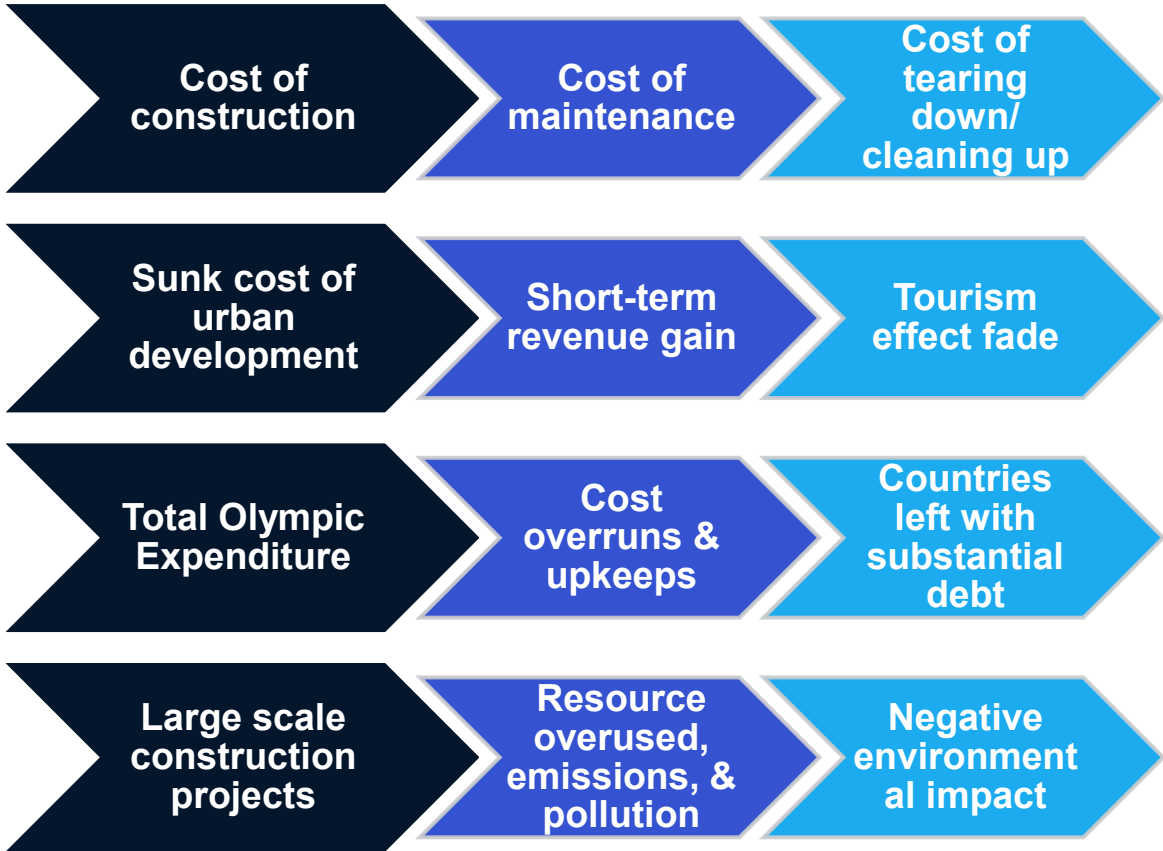
Infrastructure alone may cost between **\$5 billion and \$50 billion** before any other costs

Source: The Council on Foreign Relations

Key Takeaway: Hosting the Summer Olympics hasn't been an investment, but a liability. History shows runaway costs and short-term gains, while Florida needs long-term, resilient growth

We conducted a Cost-Benefit Analysis within a Mega-Event Hosting Evaluation Framework

Pre-Olympics During Post-Olympics



70% unused
within 5 years

Source: The Oxford Olympics Study 2024

Rio's tourism fell **4% year after Games**; London's leveled off within **2 years**

Source: Council on Foreign Relations 2021

\$20.3B
Average cost of hosting
Summer Olympics

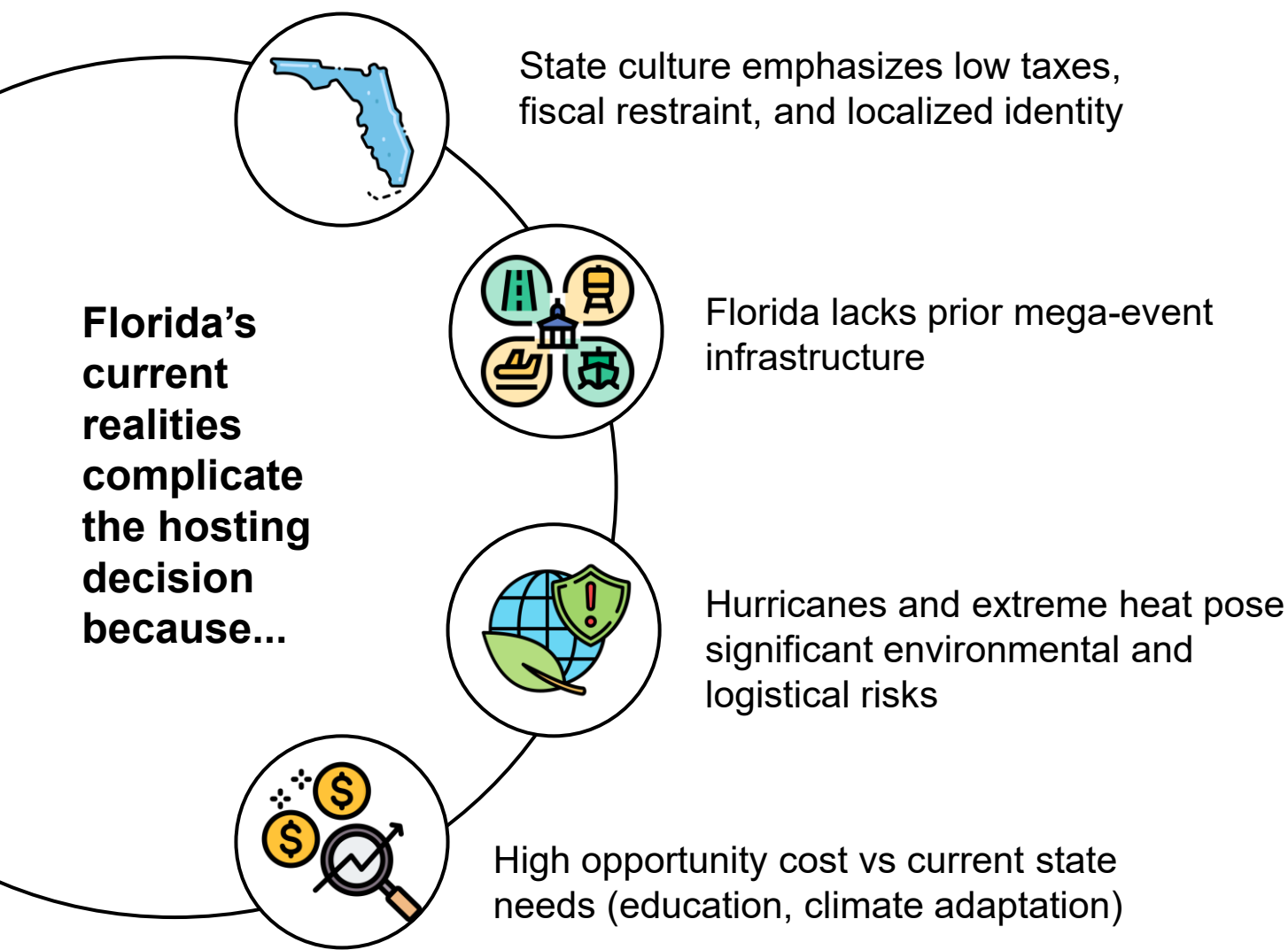
Source: CNBC

-38%
Average ROI from hosting
the Olympics/World Cup

Source: NIH

Situation

Florida’s potential bid to host the Olympics raises economic, cultural, and environmental questions



Key Insights

The Olympic cost-benefit pattern shows diminishing long-term returns
Florida would absorb the risks but not the rewards

What does it all mean?

Florida should have alternative solutions to the meet the target goals

Scope of Work

As the result, we define the scope of work that address the goals of the Summer Olympics Games

Overall Key Question:

How can Florida achieve Olympic-level tourism, economic growth, infrastructure revitalization, and appeal as a destination for Americans to move, without hosting the Games?

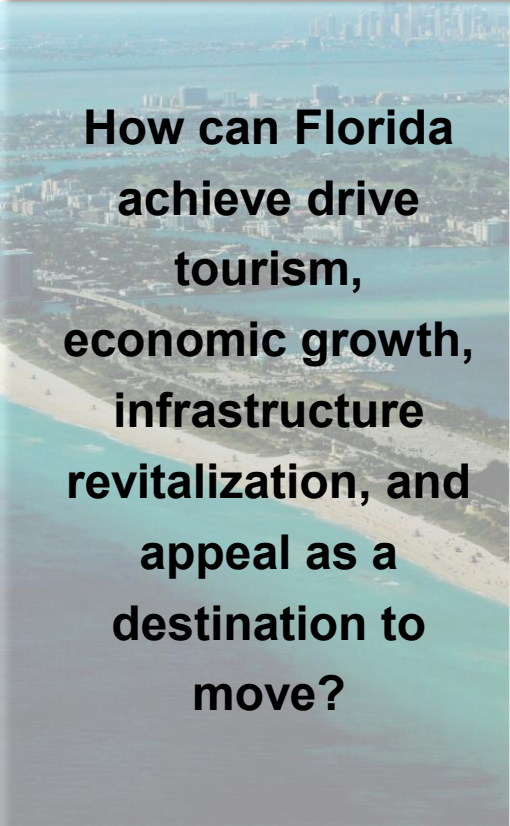
Key Tasks:



Key Criteria:



Together, our recommendations position Florida as a destination place for Americans to move

 Key Question	 Key Tasks	 Recommendations	 Impact
 How can Florida achieve drive tourism, economic growth, infrastructure revitalization, and appeal as a destination to move?	Assess Florida’s readiness and determine why hosting the Olympics is not the optimal solution	WiLD Program Sustainable tourism and eco-education initiative	35K-70K Increase in visitors to the ENP per year
	Provide alternative options to drive tourism, economic growth, infrastructure revitalization, and attract new residents	Project FLUP Florida’s Future Launch & Upskilling Park	10-15% Increase in graduate retention rate with 180K added jobs
	Quantify impact and define a long-term vision that positions Florida to thrive in these areas.	Smart Infrastructure Florida (SIF) A Climate-Resilient Revitalization Plan	20% Increase in road resilience along with 25,000 new “green” jobs created

A large Ferris wheel is the central focus, set against a dramatic sunset sky with orange, pink, and blue hues. Palm trees and other tropical vegetation are in the foreground, and a roller coaster is visible in the background to the right. The scene is illuminated by the warm light of the setting sun.

1 WiLD Program

Wildlife Education

Lodging Improvements

Dark Sky Celebration

Florida's strongest tourism asset is nature, and the Everglades is the state's most unique ecosystem

Unique Nature & Landscapes

The only place where crocodiles and alligators naturally coexist

The largest subtropical wilderness in the U.S

Everglades Demand Gap

National Parks reached a record high visitation in 2024 of 331.9 M

ENP experienced a **36% decrease** in visitation in 2024 compared to pre-pandemic levels, despite net positive changes in Florida's population

Current Limitations

Housing options

- 24 lodge rooms
- 20 eco-tents
- 38 house boats
- 274 campsites

Fragmented experience with no central hub

Sources: [IRMA](#), [CamperChamp](#)

Key Takeaway: To increase tourism, ENP must pair its scenery with education-rich and fun experiences

Unique opportunities at the Everglades National Park

Python Week



Teams of trained professionals remove invasive Burmese pythons, while visitors safely observe and learn



Promote through Social Media influencers like **Garrett Galvin** (The Yoink Guy)



Guided observer boats and roadside observation vehicles

Family-friendly nongraphic exhibits

Informational sessions

- Python biology
- Ecosystem impacts
- Detection methods

Evening debrief

- Highlights pythons captured that day

Program Components

Key Takeaway: Turn Python removal into a safe, family-friendly, media-ready experience that attracts new audiences and converts day-trippers into multi-night visitors

Encouraging overnight trips through unique lodging

Lodging Expansion



Expanding the Flamingo Lodge

- Build three new 24-room lodges
- Implement Starlink



Group Bunkhouses

- 48-room lodge targeted at schools and environmental protection groups

House Boats

- Purchase 6-10 new boats
- Refurbish the existing fleet



Build on disturbed land

- Limit footprint in a sensitive habitat

Hurricane-Proof structures

- Modular, impact-rated

Elevated on pilings

- Prepare against rising sea level concerns
- Preserves the water sheet flow

Use long-wavelength lighting

- Protects wildlife and preserves star visibility

Sustainable Development

Key Takeaway: Expanding in-park lodging will drive longer stays and shift the Everglades from a day trip to a true vacation destination

Driving tourism by leveraging the Southeast's premier dark-skies

Night Sky Center



Planetarium located in the dark core near Mahogany Hammock, which delivers stargazing and live telescope views



Indigenous Skies Evenings

- Celestial storytelling with the Miccosukee and Seminole tribes



Social media campaign during the month-long Dark Sky Celebration

Red Light boardwalks designed for stargazing

- Guided nighttime walks & bike rides

Telescope Fleet

- Astro binocular stations for wide field scans
- Dobsonian mount reflector telescope for deep sky viewing

Awareness and Implementation

Key Takeaway: A unique blend of science and culture broadens the Everglades' appeal, attracting new audiences and converting day-trippers into multi-night visitors



2 Project FLUP

Entrepreneurship & Innovation Ecosystem

Education & Workforce Development

Florida's long-term competitiveness is at risk

Florida's aging population...



Florida's median age is **42.8**, about **10% higher than** the U.S. median of **39.2**

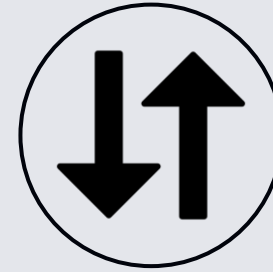
Source: Census Reporter



Only **34.9%** of Floridians aged 25+ hold a bachelor's degree, compared to **36.2%** nationally

Source: Census Reporter

Florida struggles to retain homegrown talent...



Despite strong in-migration from other states, many **Florida-raised Gen Z adults** leave after graduation due to affordability and limited to **high-skilled job opportunities**

Source: Medium



Median wages are **8% below** national average, reflecting **Florida's reliance on service-based sectors** rather than high-value industries

Source: Bureau of Labor Statistics

Key Takeaway: Without improving retention and developing higher-skill industries, Florida will struggle to build the innovation workforce needed for long-term competitiveness

A statewide initiative that transforms Florida's workforce

Value Propositions

- **Creates a** university-anchored innovation ecosystem turning **Florida's research power** into startups, jobs, and community growth
- **Closes** the literacy-to-innovation gap
- **Accelerates** startup creation
- **Builds** Florida into the nation's next talent and innovation destination

Core Models



Anchor
Universities



Startup
Launch Hubs

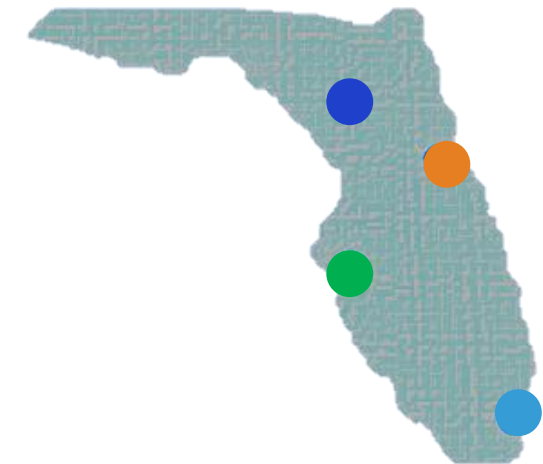


Community
Ecosystems

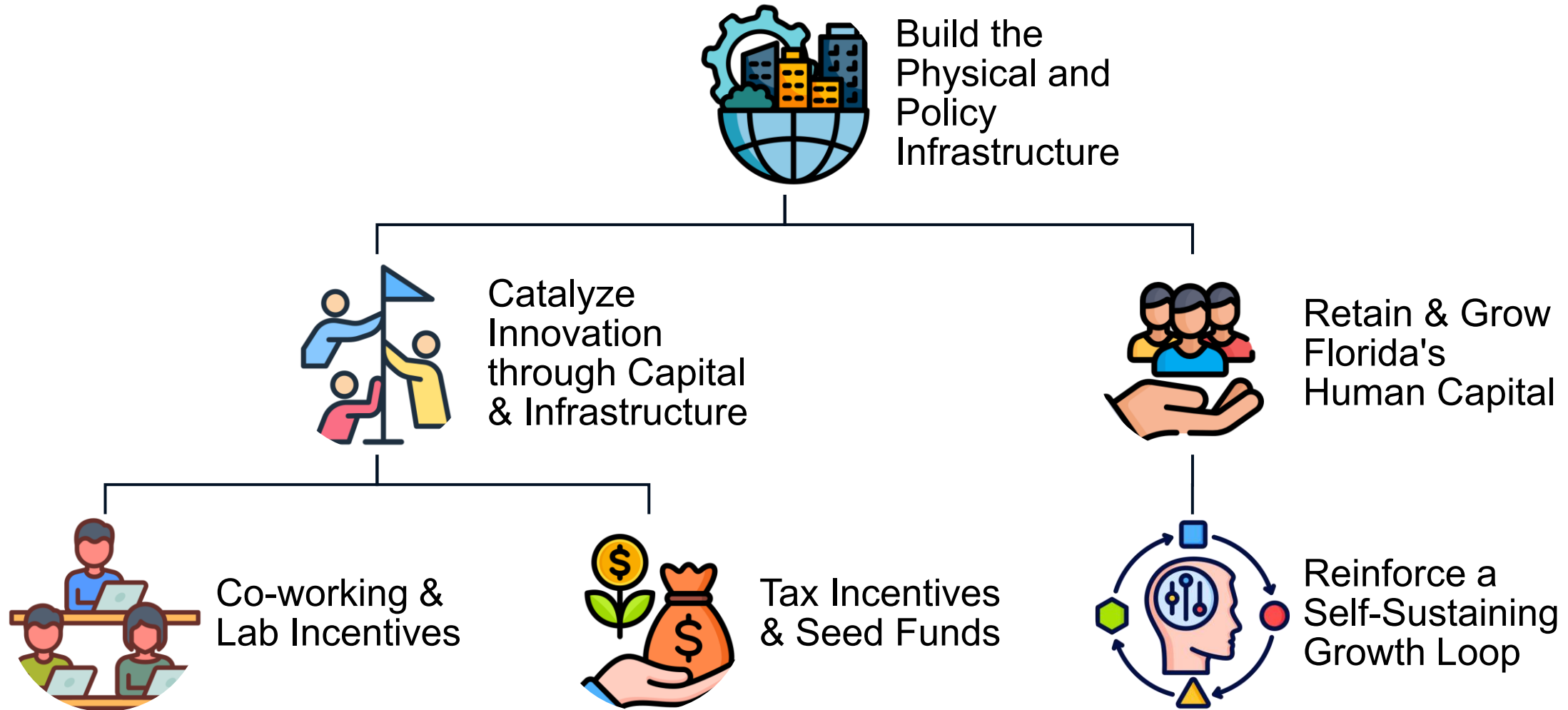


Proposed Pilot Locations

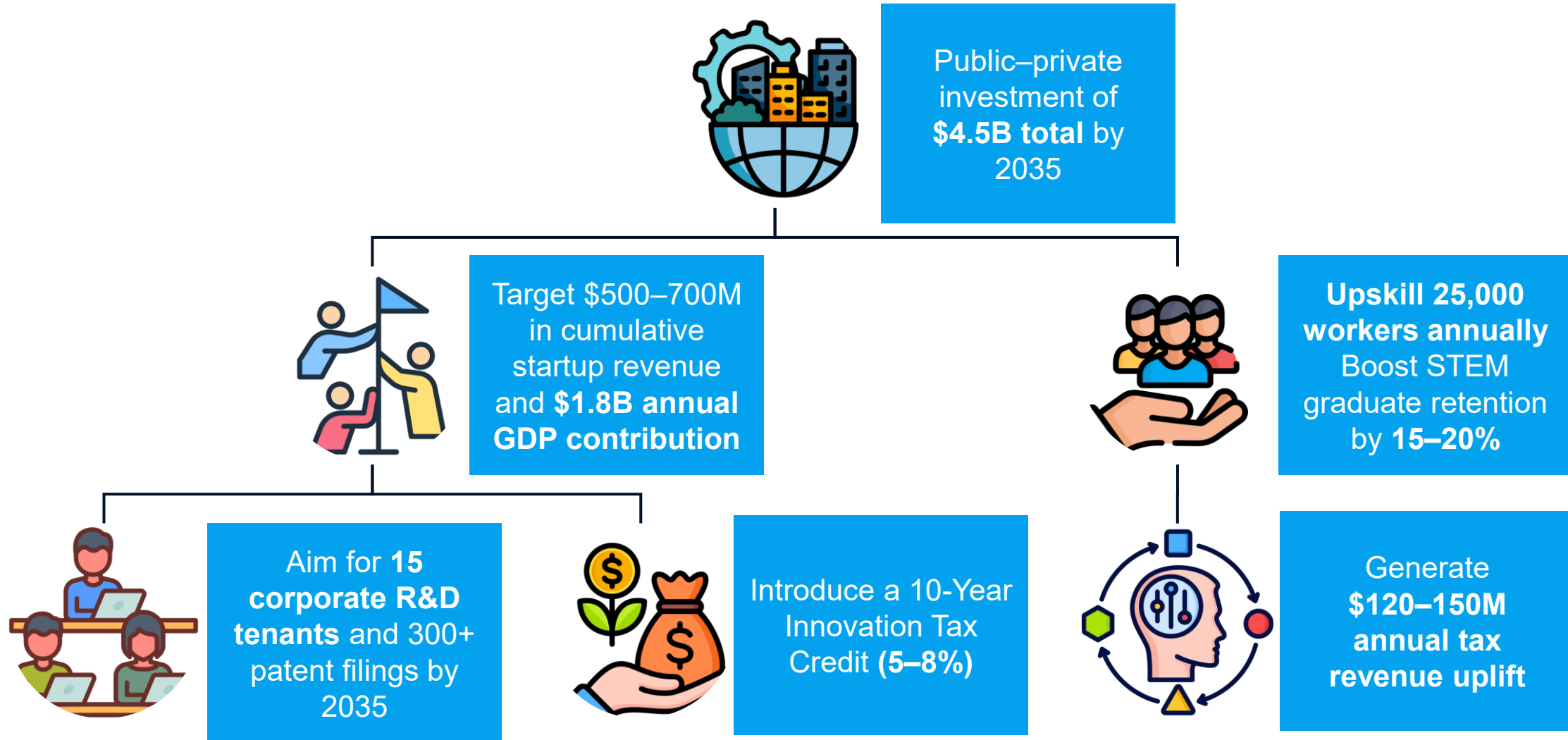
- **Gainesville**: UF Innovate District
- **Orlando**: UCF Health & Tech Corridor
- **Tampa**: USF Research Park
- **Miami / FIU**: Edge District



How FLUP Works – Anchor Universities → Startup Hubs → Community Ecosystems



How FLUP Works – Anchor Universities → Startup Hubs → Community Ecosystems



The background of the slide features a photograph of a modern building with large glass windows reflecting the sunset sky. In the foreground, there are rows of solar panels mounted on a metal frame. A dark blue diagonal shape on the left side of the slide contains the text.

3

Smart Infrastructure Florida (SIF)

Green Transit Corridor

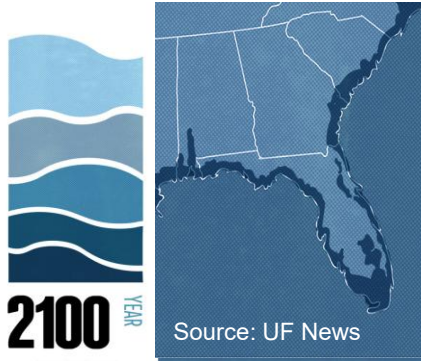
Smart Flood Management

Transition to Renewable Energy

Smart and Sustainable Infrastructure

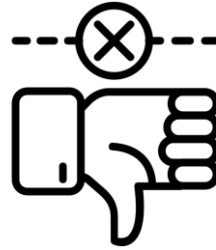
Florida's greatest constraint to achieving its goals is environmental resilience

Rising Seas, Rising Costs



- **Rising tides** accelerate **damage** to roads, bridges, and drainage systems, **inflating** maintenance and adaptation costs

Infrastructure Under Strain



Florida's infrastructure earns a **C grade** overall; stormwater systems score **D**

Olympic-scale development would add pressure to already overburdened roads and water systems

Source: ASCE, 2024

Flood-Prone Transport & Roadways



Florida's **47K miles of roads** and **3.6K bridges** face recurring flood and erosion damage

Expanding transit for the Olympics would compound the costs

Source: NBC Miami, 2024

Key Takeaway: Climate volatility turns Florida's Olympic ambitions into a structural risk

A Climate-Resilient Revitalization Plan



Green Transit Corridors

- Expand flood-resistant rail and bus systems connecting major cities
 - Miami
 - Orlando
 - Tampa
 - Gainesville
 - Jacksonville
 - Tallahassee



Smart Flood Management

- Implement adaptive drainage systems and permeable road materials in coastal zones.
- Road raising can also be implemented in Flood-prone areas.



Energy Transition

- Build decentralized solar microgrids to strengthen power resilience during storms.
- Expand subsidies for rooftop solar panels, leveraging “Sunshine State” advantage



Digital Infrastructure

- Invest in broadband and smart sensors to monitor traffic and weather conditions in real time.
- Expand 5G and fiber coverage across urban corridors and vulnerable rural regions.

Investing now prevents future losses and enhances economic competitiveness.

Partner with **FDOT, private developers, and federal resilience grants (FEMA BRIC)** for co-funded projects

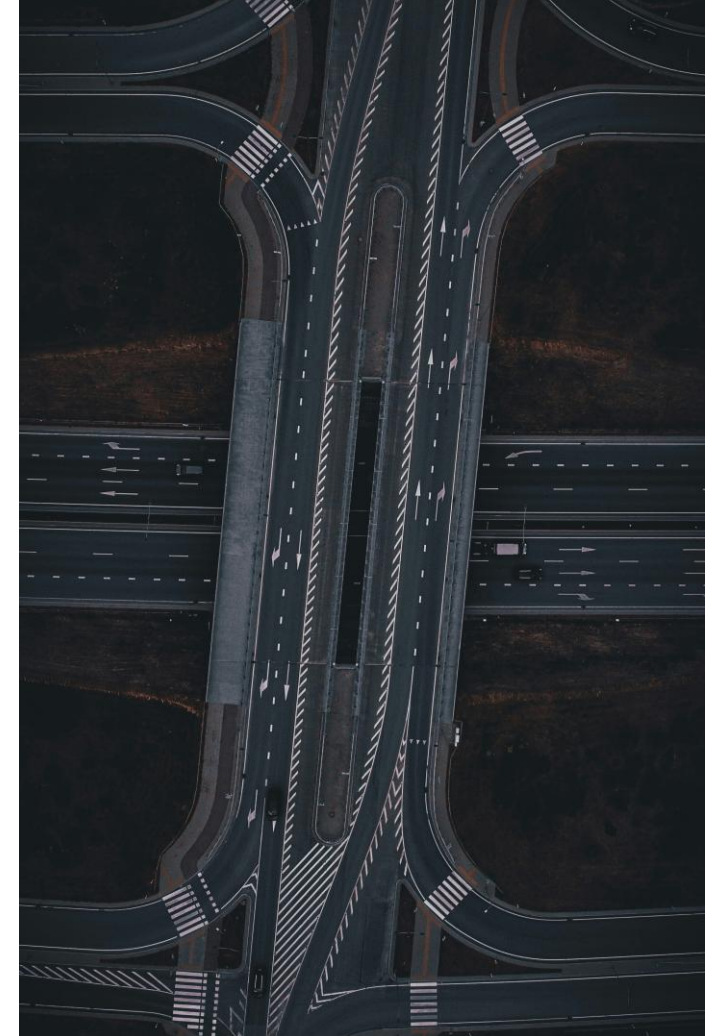
Pilot “Resilience Innovation Districts” in Miami and Tampa, modeled after Singapore’s One-North and Boston’s Seaport

Integrate public dashboards tracking emissions reduction, travel efficiency, and community impact

+20% improvement in road resilience by 2035

\$10–15B private sector co-investment

25,000 long-term green jobs created



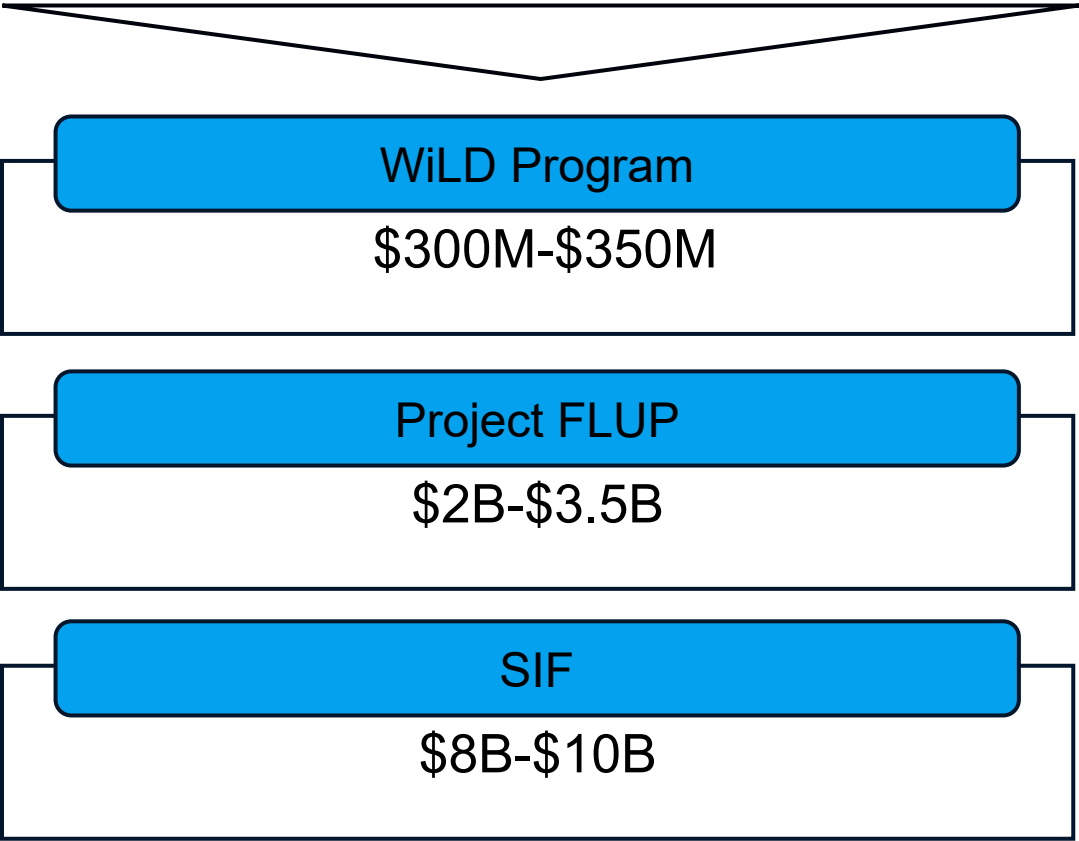
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Financials

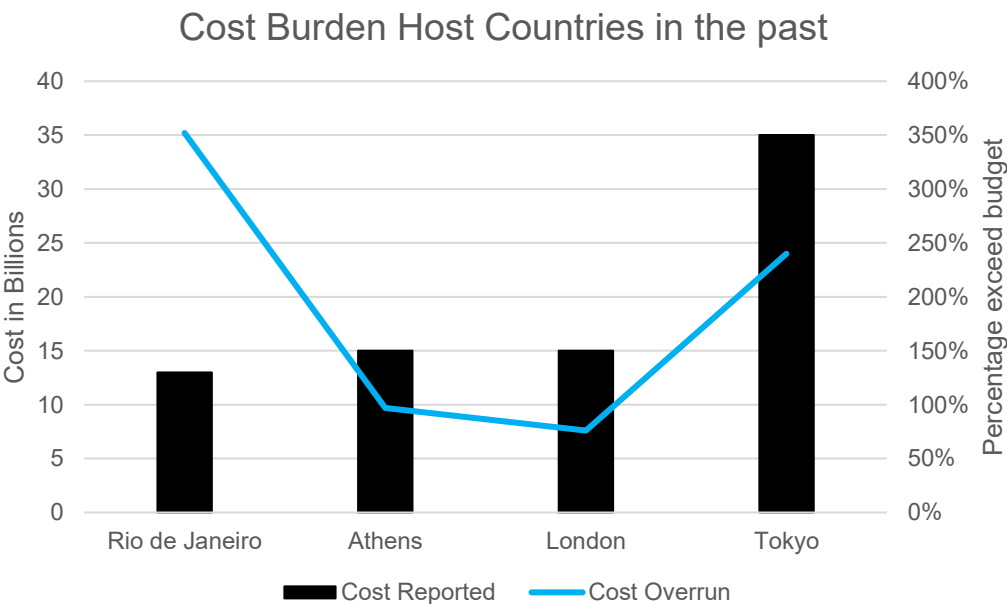


The total cost projected for our recommendations vs. hosting the Sunshine State Games

It would cost 10.3 – 13.85B
to implement our strategies



Approximate Total Cost Incurred for Host Countries



Olympics Cost > WiLD + FLUP + SIF

Projected impact

14%

Increase in statewide economic activity (from tourism, workforce, & infrastructure boosts)

\$13.34B

Total combined investment across the three strategies (WiLD + FLUP + SIF, 2025–2040 horizon)

3.5X

Each \$1 yields \$3–4 in long-term value invested

\$43.29B

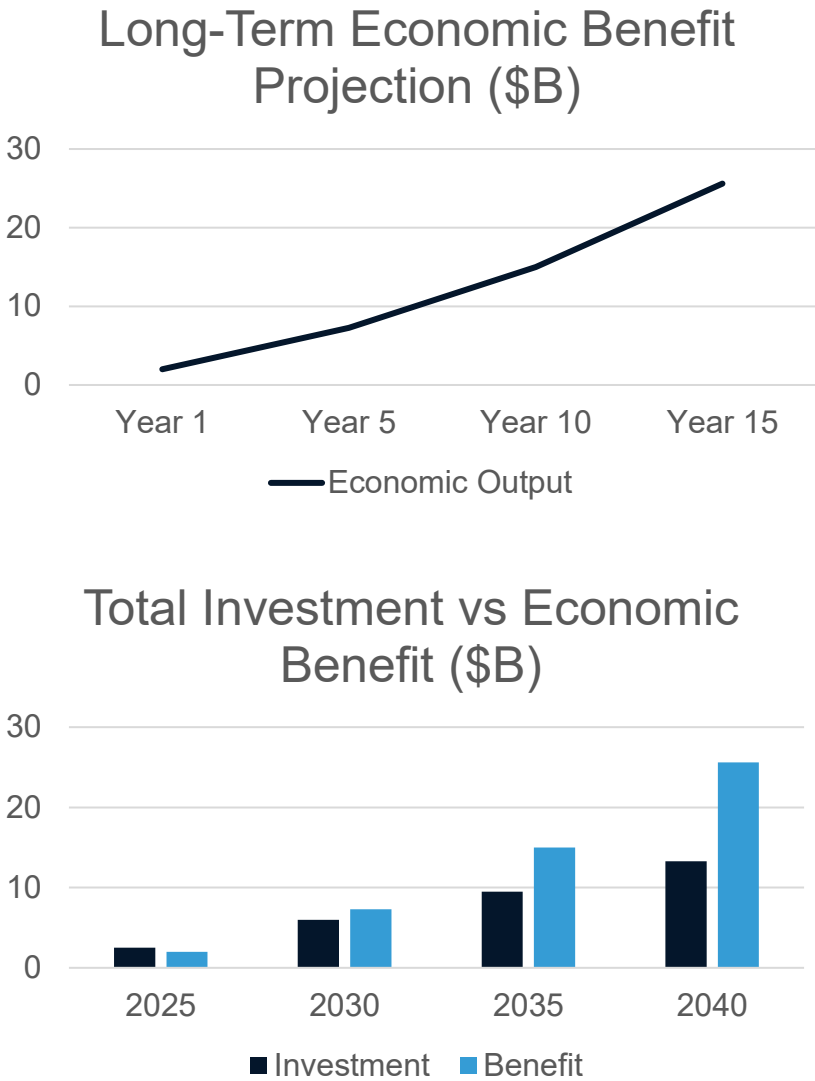
Projected statewide economic impact by Year 15

\$2.0B in Year 1 (2025)

14% increase per year

Economic benefit grows

1X – 4X from Y1 to Y5



Implementation Timeline

A coordinated 10-15-year roadmap guides the phased rollout of all three strategies

Today's Action Steps		Implementation Timeline					
			2026-2028	2029-2031	2032-2035	2036-2038	2039-2041
1	Address Regulatory Concerns	WiLD Program	Build initial 24-room eco-lodge and Launch Events	Extend eco-lodging, formalize education, expand marketing	Develop planetarium/night-sky center, integrate storytelling	Reach self-sustaining status via eco-tourism revenue	Evaluate project success through KPI metrics
2	Establish the FLUP Taskforce	Project FLUP	Establish and Learn from Pilot Districts in Orlando and Gainesville	Open additional parks, create talent network, introduce SIF	Reach 5000+ graduates, achieve 10% increase in median wages	Transition to public-private management model	Evaluate project success through KPI metrics
3	Kickstart a Pilot Collaboration	Smart Infrastructure Florida (SIF)	Start conducting studies and begin pilot projects	Expand green transit, deploy smart technology, secure funds	Complete statewide resilience, achieve 25% renewable energy usage	Scale infrastructure models to coastal/rural region	Publish resilience report and evaluate success through KPIs
		ANALYSIS	RECOMMENDATION		FINANCIALS		

5 Evaluation



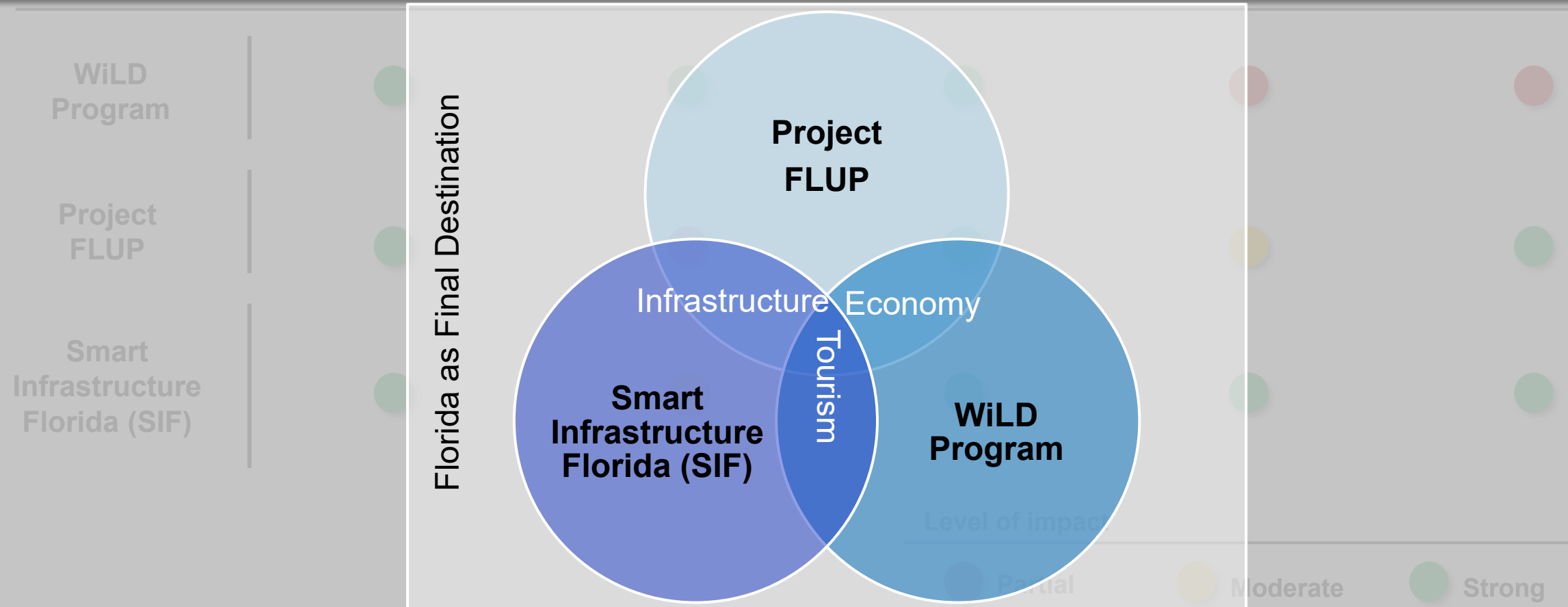
We conducted an analysis to ensure that each recommendation delivers measurable progress

Alternatives	Feasibility & Resilience	Tourism Growth	Economic Competitiveness	Infrastructure Revitalization	Attract New Residents
WiLD Program					
Project FLUP					
Smart Infrastructure Florida (SIF)					

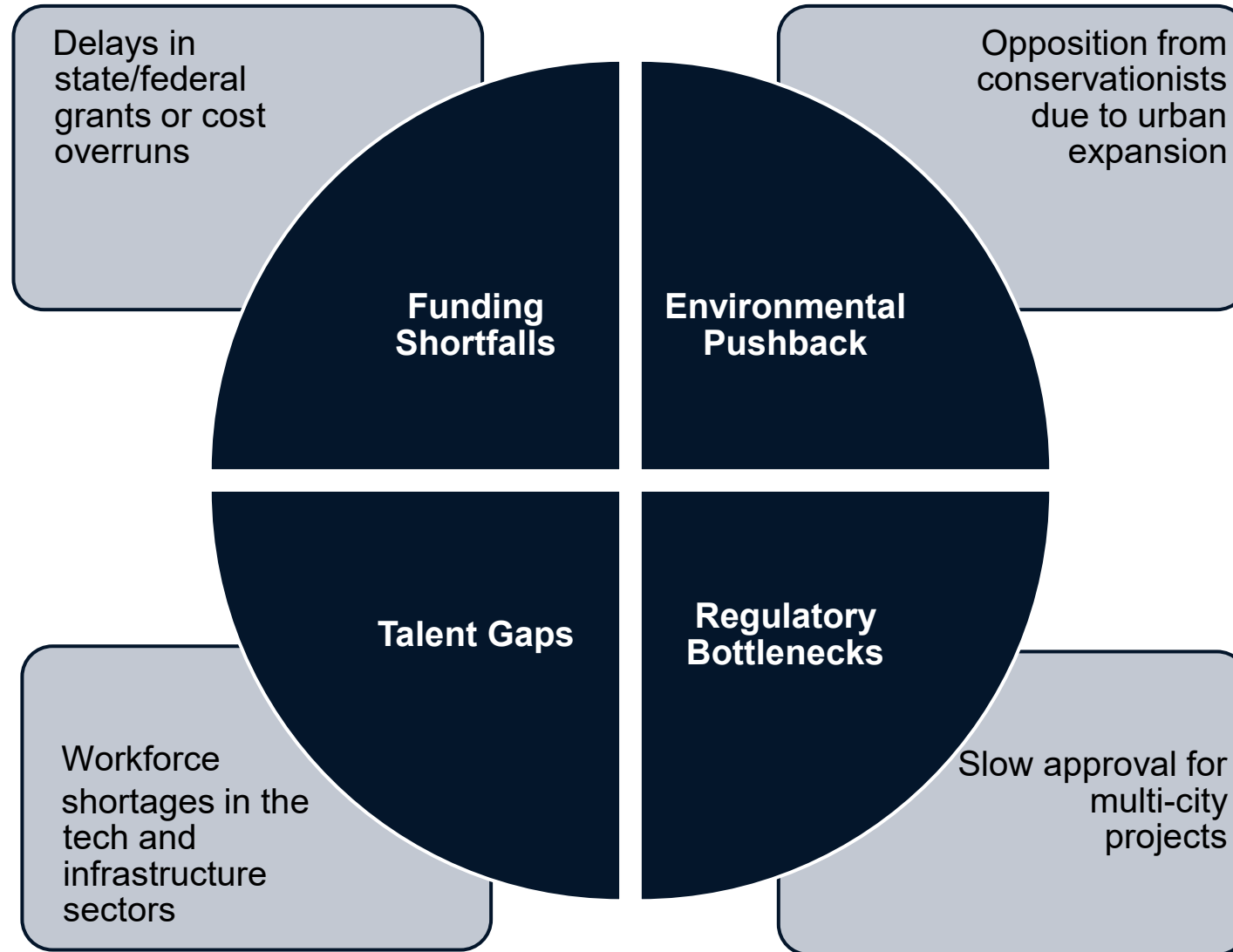
Level of impact

 Partial  Moderate  Strong

Key Insight: No single recommendation meets all goals but together, they deliver Florida's strategic objectives at a lower cost and higher legacy value than hosting the Olympics.



Our team anticipated some risks...



Mitigation

...that can be mitigated through the following actions

Funding Shortfalls

Establish a **Public-Private Partnership Fund** and phased investment rollout

Environmental Pushback

Incorporate **net-zero construction** and environmental offset programs

Talent Gaps

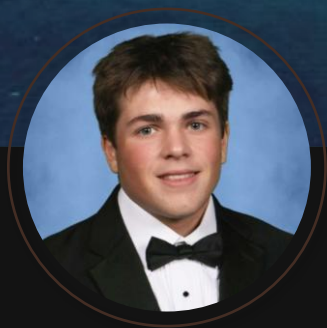
Coordinate with **Project FLUP** to train local workers

Regulatory Bottlenecks

Create a **State Infrastructure Task Force** to streamline processes

Thank You For Listening!

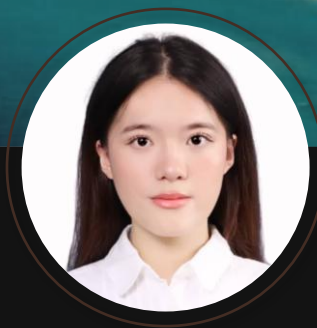
Dallas Team



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Max



My



Rachel



Vedaant

6 Appendix



Inspired by LaunchPad Singapore @One North

Example



LaunchPad One-North

Source: JTC

Highlights

These startups contribute significant revenue: one article cites **S\$400 million (US\$290 million) in cumulative revenue** generated by firms at LaunchPad

Since launch in 2015 it has housed **over 1,300 startups**

The ecosystem includes proximity to universities, research institutes and corporate R&D, enabling collaboration, and “plug-and-play” startup spaces

Inspired by LaunchPad Singapore @One North

Benchmarks: - **LaunchPad @One-North (Singapore)** – 1,300 startups, US\$290M cumulative revenue.

[JTC LaunchPad info page](#) - **Boston Seaport Innovation District** – 8,000 jobs, +5% local GDP lift since 2015.

[Atlas of Urban Tech – Case Study](#) - **Singapore Enterprise Portal for Jobs & Skills** – streamlined startup licensing model.

[Singapore Enterprise Portal Overview](#)

Benchmarks: - **Startup SG Fund (Singapore)** – Achieved 1:6 public–private leverage ratio (\$8.2B private for \$1.3B public).

[Enterprise Singapore – Startup SG Equity](#) - **Station F (Paris)** – 1,000 startups incubated, €250M investment in 7 years.

[Station F Official Site](#) - **McKinsey Global Institute Report (2022)** – Innovation infrastructure ROI (1 USD → 3.4 USD GDP).

[McKinsey Global Institute – Innovation Infrastructure Insights](#)

Benchmarks: - **LaunchPad One-North** – 25% occupancy by global tech firms (JTC, 2023).

[JTC LaunchPad Overview](#) - **Austin Innovation Corridor** – 60% early tenants converted to long-term leases.

[Austin Innovation District Market Analysis \(Perkins + Will\)](#) - **Brookings Institution (2021)** – Innovation districts job multiplier: 2.0× indirect jobs.

[Brookings Innovation Districts Report](#)

Benchmarks: - **Texas Enterprise Fund (TEF)** – 75,000 jobs from \$650M grants (2022).

[Texas Governor’s Office – TEF Program](#) - **Startup SG Equity (Singapore)** – \$1.8B follow-on funding within 5 years.

[Seeds Capital Partnership Info Pack](#) - **National Venture Capital Association (2023)** – 1:5 average leverage ratio on early-stage co-investment.

[NVCA Yearbook 2023](#)

Benchmarks: - **SkillsFuture Singapore** – 500,000 workers trained per year; \$1.5B investment.

[SkillsFuture SG Overview](#) - **Boston Innovation District** – 22% growth in local tech employment over 10 years.

[Boston Planning & Development Agency Report](#) - **Brookings Talent Ecosystem Report (2021)** – Human capital retention through localized innovation ecosystems.

[Brookings Talent Retention Report](#)

Benchmarks: - **Austin Innovation Ecosystem** – 3.0× GDP multiplier effect; 2.6× regional innovation ROI.

[Brookings Metro – Austin Innovation Ecosystem](#) - **Singapore’s One-North** – 40% self-financed expansion via tenant reinvestment.

[JTC One-North Development Overview](#) - **OECD Regional Innovation Study (2023)** – Innovation clusters achieve sustained 2–3× long-term ROI.

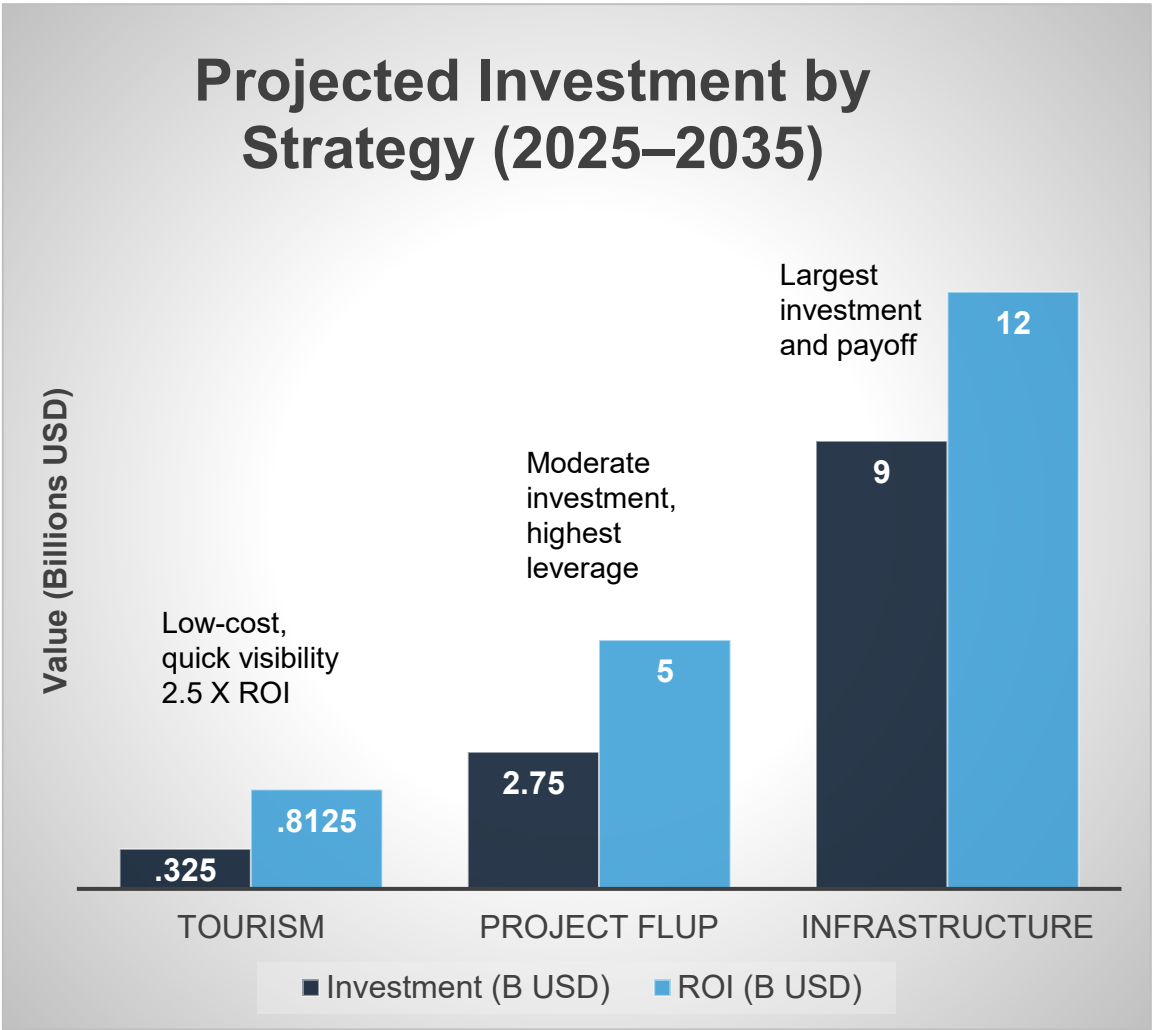
[OECD Innovation Clusters Report](#)

Benchmark Case for Cost Breakdown

Cost Area	Estimated Cost (USD B)	Rationale / Benchmark Case
Green Transit Corridors	\$3B	Based on <i>California High-Speed Rail</i> and <i>Florida Brightline</i> costs (\$30M–\$60M/mile incl. resilience retrofits). Six major city connectors = ~100 miles.
Smart Flood Management	\$1.8B	Modeled after <i>New Orleans’ Southeast Louisiana Urban Flood Control Project</i> (SELAFP, \$2.3B). Scaled for Florida coastal zones.
Energy Transition (Solar Microgrids)	\$2B	Reference: <i>Puerto Rico microgrid modernization program</i> (\$2B plan covering 1.5M homes). Florida’s target: 1M homes.
Digital Infrastructure (Smart sensors + broadband)	\$1.2B	<i>National Broadband Expansion Plan</i> benchmarks at ~\$20,000/mile. Florida’s rural + coastal coverage ~200K miles.
Total Estimated Investment	\$8B	Phased over 10 years (2025–2035).

Estimated Project Costs based on past projects

Category	Estimated Cost (USD B)	Funding Source	Comparable Benchmark
Project FLUP (Innovation Hubs + Upskilling Parks)	2.0 – 3.5 B	State innovation grants + private VC + federal education funds	Texas Innovation Corridor (\$2.5 B, 2022)
WiLD Program (National Park Upgrades + Marketing)	300 – 350M	FL Dept. of Economic Opportunity + Visit Florida + National Park Service	Gulf State Park Enhancement Project (\$140 M, 2016)
Smart Infrastructure (Green Transit + Microgrids + Flood Systems)	8 – 10 B	FEMA BRIC + Infrastructure Investment and Jobs Act (IIJA) + Public-Private Partnerships	Miami Coastal Defense Project (\$9.2 B, 2024)
Total Investment Range	10.3 – 13.85 B	Hybrid public-private model	—



Financial Calculations

1. For the +20% Improvement in Road Resilience by 2035:
Baseline: Florida has ≈ 275,000 lane miles of public roads (FDOT, 2024).
Assume *critical coastal & intercity corridors* = 100,000 miles.
Upgrading ~55,000 miles (~20%) with flood-resistant materials, adaptive drainage, and raised grades = measurable resilience improvement.

$$= (55,000 \div 275,000) \times 100 = 20\%$$

Case Study	Result	Relevance
Netherlands “Room for the River” Program (2007–2022)	22% flood resilience improvement nationwide	Adaptive drainage + raised roads in coastal areas
Louisiana SELA Flood Control Project (2018–2023)	15–18% reduction in annual flood damage	Urban drainage investment comparable to Florida
Miami Forever Bond Projects (2020–2024)	Raised roads increased storm drainage capacity by 20–25%	City-scale precedent

2. For the \$10–15 B Private Sector Co-Investment
Targeted leverage from **Public-Private Partnerships (PPP)**, **energy utilities**, and **real estate developers**.
Florida precedent suggests high PPP participation rates in infrastructure & energy projects.

$$\text{Private co-investment} = \text{Public funding} \times \text{Leverage ratio}$$

Assume \$9 B total public infrastructure investment (state + federal).
Leverage ratio of 1.1–1.6x (from existing PPP models):
= \$9 B × (1.1–1.6) ≈ **\$10–15 B** private co-investment potential.

Case	Investment Structure	Public : Private Ratio	Outcome
Florida Brightline Rail Expansion	\$5 B total; \$3.5 B private	1 : 1.4	Successful PPP; low fiscal risk

Florida Power & Light “SolarTogether” Program	\$1.5 B private-led investment	1 : 1.5	Proof of utility-driven capital mobilization
Texas Tollway PPP Model	\$7 B total; \$4 B private	1 : 1.6	Benchmark for transport corridor financing

3. For the 25,000 Long-Term Green Jobs Created
Infrastructure job creation follows established multipliers (World Bank, Brookings, DOE).

Average:
1,000 direct jobs per \$1 B infrastructure investment;
green projects ≈ 1.2x multiplier.

$$25,000 = \$9\text{B} \times 1,000 \times 1.2 \times 2.3$$

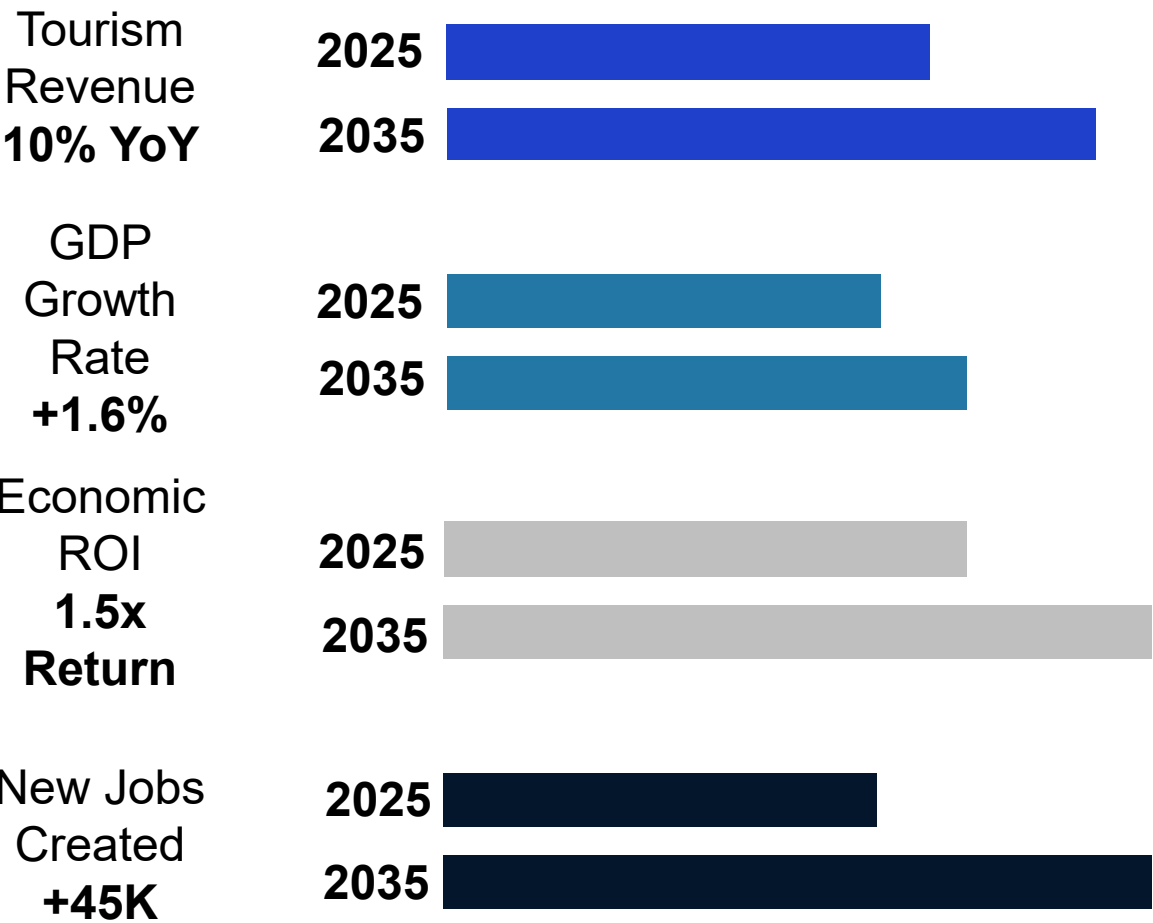
(2.3 = combined direct + indirect + induced job multiplier from Brookings)

Case	Investment Scale	Jobs Created	Source
California High-Speed Rail Phase 1	\$9 B	30,000 jobs	CA HSR Authority (2023)
U.S. Green Infrastructure Stimulus (2021)	\$82 B	1 M jobs	Brookings Institution (2021)
Puerto Rico Grid Modernization (DOE, 2023)	\$12 B	20,000 jobs	U.S. DOE Resilience Division

Projected impact

Category / Assumption	Projected Value	Rationale (Real-World Evidence)	Comparable Benchmark / Source
Total Investment (2025–2040)	\$13.34 B (mid-case)	Sum of FLUP (\$2–3.5 B), WiLD (\$0.35 B), and SIF (\$8–10 B) — consistent with major U.S. regional programs combining infrastructure, innovation, and sustainability.	Texas Innovation Corridor (2022): \$2.5 B; Miami Coastal Defense (2024): \$9.2 B
Initial Economic Output (2025)	\$2.0 B	Represents early-phase benefits from tourism recovery, construction jobs, and hub activity ~15 % of total capital, consistent with short-run regional multiplier (~1.5×).	U.S. BEA Regional Multipliers; Gulf State Park Enhancement (2016)
Long-Term Growth (CAGR)	~20 % average (front-loaded S-curve)	Early acceleration from infrastructure rollout and tourism rebound, tapering to steady 11–15 % growth, similar to innovation cluster scaling patterns.	Singapore Smart Nation (14 % CAGR avg.); Austin Tech Corridor (16–18 %)
ROI (Economic Return)	3.5× investment value	Weighted average of tourism (2–7×), innovation (4–8×), and resilience infrastructure (4–6×). Conservative midpoint of published federal estimates.	NIBS Mitigation ROI Study (2020): \$6 benefit / \$1 invested; FEMA BRIC (2023)
Cumulative Statewide Economic Impact (by 2040)	\$43.3 B	Computed as 3.25× investment (\$13.34 B × 3.25 ≈ \$43.3 B); in line with statewide output from similar multi-sector investments.	National Park Service Visitor Economy (2023): \$55.6 B output, 415k jobs
Jobs Created	≈ 180 K (by 2040)	Based on sector multipliers: 10–13 jobs / \$1 M infra investment, 3–5 / \$1 M innovation, 16 / \$1 M tourism spend.	U.S. Bureau of Economic Analysis; NPS Tourism Jobs Impact (2023)
Annual Economic Activity Growth	14 % (avg.)	Matches Florida’s projected 2020s GDP growth in high-tech + infrastructure sectors under ARPA & IJA funding cycles.	Florida Chamber Foundation 2030 Report Card (2024)

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)



Projected progress toward 2035 targets (based on comparable state initiatives).

 **Key Metrics**

 **Tourism Revenue**

 **GDP Growth Rate**

 **Economic ROI**

 **# of Jobs Created**

Funding Sources

Funding Source	% Contribution	Example / Rationale
Federal Grants (IIJA, FEMA BRIC, DOE)	35%	Infrastructure resilience, clean energy transition
State Government (Florida DOT, DEO)	25%	Transportation modernization, tourism enhancement
Private Sector & Venture Investment	30%	FLUP startup hubs, microgrid innovation
Tourism Revenue / Eco-Levy	10%	Sustainable funding stream through visitor surcharges
Total	100%	Hybrid model ensures long-term fiscal sustainability

